me most was what I saw as the rise of fascism in our country, the very thing we had fought to obliterate.

Scores of new veterans' groups had sprouted up around the country and were trying to peddle some of the same venom of fascist bigotry that we had just defeated in the war.

In Hollywood, as I've often said, if you don't sing or dance, you end up as an after-dinner speaker. And almost before I knew it, I was speaking out against the rise of neofascism in America.

I joined just about any organization I could find that guaranteed to save the world, like the United World Federalists and American Veterans Committee, which got me with their slogan: "A Citizen First, a Veteran Afterward." I really wanted a better world and I think I thought what I was saying would help bring it about.

One day after giving one of my speeches to the men's club at the Hollywood Beverly Christian Church where I worshiped, our pastor came up to me and said he agreed with what I'd said about the rise of neofascism. But he said: "I think your speech would be even better if you also mentioned that if Communism ever looked like a threat, you'd be just as opposed to it as you are to fascism."

Well, during the war, the Russians had been our allies, and I'd dismissed the people after the war who had started to denounce them as foolish and paranoid.

I told the minister I hadn't given much thought to the threat of Communism but the suggestion seemed like a good one and that I'd begin saying if the day came when it also posed a threat to American values, I'd be just as strongly opposed to it as I was to fascism.

Not long afterward, I was asked to give a speech to a local citizens' organization. I made my usual speech defending American values against the new fascism that seemed to be abroad in the land and was applauded after almost every